
A T E A M P R I M E R

Prompt Engineering

for smarter, faster marketing.

How clear instructions to AI models can compress hours of work into minutes — and lift the quality of every campaign we ship.

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What is prompt engineering?

Prompt engineering is the practice of designing the inputs we give a generative AI model so it returns more accurate, relevant, and useful outputs.

Think of it as briefing a brilliant new hire: the clearer the brief, the better the work.

Clarity

Plain, specific instructions

Context

What the model needs to know

Constraints

Length, tone, format

“

*A great prompt
isn't long — it's
loaded.*

Every word does work: role, task, audience, format.

Where this pays off in marketing

10×

**more variations explored
per brief**

Test more headlines, hooks and angles before committing.

60%

less time on first drafts

Skip the blank page on briefs, copy, recaps and recap decks.

1:1

personalization at scale

Tailor by segment, persona, channel and stage of funnel.



Better briefs in. Better creative out. Time back to think.

Prompt engineering is the leverage point — small inputs, outsized output gains.

The five parts of a great prompt

1

Role

Tell the model who it is. "You are a senior B2B copywriter."

2

Task

State the deliverable in one line. What do we want produced?

3

Context

Audience, brand voice, product, prior campaign, source data.

4

Constraints

Length, tone, format, what to include, what to avoid.

5

Examples

1–3 samples of what "good" looks like. Few-shot beats explanation.

Four moves worth memorizing



Role assignment

Cast the model in a role: brand strategist, SEO editor, performance analyst.



Few-shot prompting

Show 1–3 worked examples of the input → output you want. Patterns beat prose.



Chain-of-thought

Ask the model to reason step by step before answering. Better logic, fewer leaps.



Retrieval & context

Paste in the brief, the data, the brand book. Don't make the model guess.

Campaign copy & messaging

WEAK PROMPT

"Write me three Instagram captions for our new running shoe."

Result

Generic captions, wrong tone, no hook to the offer or audience.

STRONG PROMPT

You are our brand copywriter. Write 5 Instagram captions for the launch of the Stride Pro running shoe — audience: urban runners 25–40 training for a first half-marathon. Tone: warm, confident, not hype. Each ≤120 chars. Include the hook 'Built for the long road.' Avoid clichés like 'unleash' and 'game-changing.'

Audience research & personas

Use AI to pressure-test personas, surface objections, and draft segment-specific messaging — in minutes, not weeks.

- ✓ Build draft personas from a product brief
- ✓ Generate likely objections by segment
- ✓ Translate jargon into customer language
- ✓ Spot whitespace between competitor positioning

EXAMPLE PROMPT

Persona pressure-test

Act as a skeptical buyer in the persona below.

Persona: marketing ops lead at a 200-person SaaS, evaluating analytics tools, burned by past migrations.

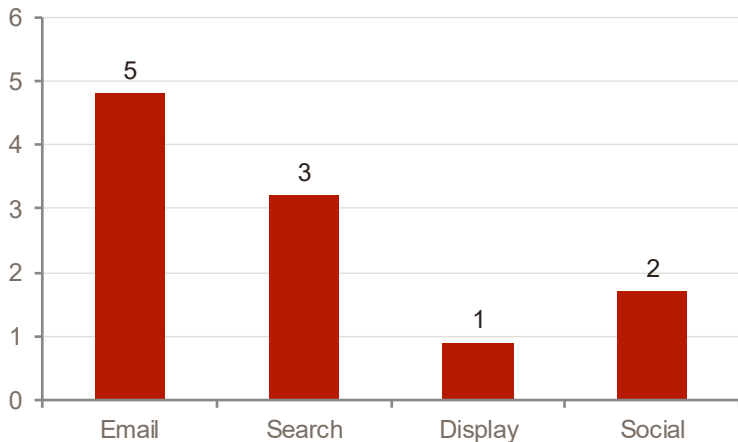
Read this landing-page draft and list:

- (1) the top 3 objections you'd raise,
- (2) the proof you'd need to overcome each,
- (3) one line that would make you click 'Book a demo.'

Analytics & reporting

Q1 CAMPAIGN PERFORMANCE

Click-through rate by channel



EXAMPLE PROMPT

From numbers to narrative

You are a marketing analyst.
Below is the CTR by channel for our Q1 campaign.

Write a 5-bullet exec summary for the CMO that:
states the headline finding, names the underperformer,
hypothesizes a cause, recommends one reallocation for Q2, and flags
one risk.

Tone: confident but hedged on causality. ≤90 words.

Best practices & common pitfalls

DO

Brief like a person

Role, task, audience, format, examples.

Iterate, don't restart

Refine the prompt; ask the model to revise.

Show, don't tell

Paste examples of the output you want.

Verify the facts

Models confabulate — check claims and stats.

AVOID

Vague one-liners

"Write me copy" yields generic copy.

Confidential data

No PII, contracts, or unreleased financials in prompts.

Set-and-forget output

Always edit — voice and accuracy still need a human.

Prompt injection blind spots

Treat third-party text as untrusted input.

W H A T ' S N E X T

Three things to try this week.

01

Save your best prompts

Start a shared library — campaign briefs, recap templates, persona tests.

02

Pick one workflow

Choose the highest-volume task on your plate and rebuild it as a prompt.

03

Share back wins

Post one before/after in #marketing-ai by Friday — we'll learn together.

Questions? Bring a tough brief — we'll workshop the prompt live.